

Basic AWS Interview Questions & Answers

Q: What is AWS?

A: AWS (Amazon Web Services) is a cloud platform where you can build apps and store data without owning servers.

Q: Benefits of AWS?

A: No need for servers, pay-as-you-go, easy to scale, available worldwide.

Q: Availability Zones vs Regions?

A: Region = big area (like US-East). AZ = data centers inside a region.

Q: Shared Responsibility Model?

A: AWS secures hardware; you secure your data and access.

Q: What is EC2?

A: A virtual server to run your app.

Q: EC2 vs Lambda?

A: EC2: always running. Lambda: runs only when needed (serverless).

Q: What are security groups?

A: Firewall rules for EC2, controlling what traffic is allowed.

Q: What is Auto Scaling?

A: Automatically adjusts number of EC2s based on traffic.

Q: What is an AMI?

A: A saved version of an EC2 setup (template).

Q: What is S3?

A: Online file storage (like Google Drive).

Q: S3 vs EBS?

A: S3 = file storage. EBS = virtual hard disk for EC2.

Q: What is EFS?

A: Shared file storage for multiple EC2s.

Q: What is an S3 bucket policy?

A: Rules that control who can access your files.

Q: What is IAM?

A: Controls who can do what in AWS.

Q: IAM user vs role?

A: User = real person. Role = temporary access for services.

Q: What is least privilege?

A: Only give needed permissions, nothing extra.

Q: How to secure S3?

A: Block public access, use IAM policies, encryption, signed URLs.

Q: What is a VPC?

A: Your own private network in AWS.

Q: Public vs Private subnet?

A: Public = internet access. Private = no direct internet.

Q: Security group vs NACL?

A: SG = controls EC2. NACL = controls subnet.

Q: What is API Gateway?

A: Manages APIs that connect to AWS services.

Q: API Gateway + Lambda?

A: API call triggers Lambda to run code.

Q: SNS vs SQS?

A: SNS = send to many. SQS = message queue.

Q: What is CloudWatch?

A: Monitors AWS services (logs, metrics, alerts).

Q: Monitor Lambda?

A: Use CloudWatch Logs to see execution and errors.

Q: RDS vs DynamoDB?

A: RDS = SQL. DynamoDB = NoSQL.

Q: DynamoDB throughput?

A: Number of reads/writes per second.

Q: Horizontal vs Vertical scaling?

A: Horizontal = add servers. Vertical = upgrade one server.

Q: Design highly available backend?

A: Use multi-AZ EC2, RDS, load balancer, S3.

Q: How to handle secrets?

A: Use AWS Secrets Manager or Parameter Store.